EUROPEAN COMMISSION

MEETING MINUTES

Date:	*28/07/2026*
Location:	*TEAMS Videoconference*
Name(s) and function(s) of the Commission representative(s):	***Céline GAUER, Director-General for Energy****, together with ENER officials.*
Name(s) of the interest representative(s):	*Business for CBAM Coalition*
Subject matter:	*Exchange on Business for CBAM Coalition proposal for a strong and ambitious ETS1, including a meaningful carbon price to support European Competitiveness.*
Main points raised and positions expressed:	• The CBAM Coalition presented itself and expressed their views on the importance of a robust ETS as central instrument for decarbonisation that drives the business case of the industries represented in the Coalition; called for a robust CBAM, noted that strong carbon pricing served these companies to reinvent themselves and become competitive; expressed concerns on changes to the ETS Linear Reduction Factor (LRF) as well as delays/extensions to the phase-out of free allowances, and the potential inclusion of international credits. The Coalition also noted the importance of affordable electricity for the steel sector. • The Coalition also expressed strong support for earmarking ETS revenues of Member States toward industrial decarbonisation and welcome the ETS Investment Booster design to support ambitious investments, including production-based support with fixed carbon premia for avoided CO_2, while noting unclarity on whether existing low-carbon production is also eligible. In addition, the Coalition expressed support on conditionalities for free allowances

	allocation from 2031, including that best performers are exempted from conditionalities. • The Coalition informed of a joint letter sent to the European Commission asking to preserve high decarbonisation ambitions.
Conclusions:	DG ENER thank for the description of the businesses, propose the CBAM Coalition to gather data and info on their business cases and the relevance of ETS and CBAM to preserve industrial decarbonisation and competitiveness, and the potential of demand-side flexibility. ENER informed of the needs to address energy costs, which include structural measures (energy mix, efficient networks) as well as short-term relief.